IT303 Software Engineering Course Project

Secure File Sharing with Encryption

User Manual

This guide walks through the actions available on the Secure File Sharing website, including account access, encrypted transfers, account settings, and administrator audit tools. Each step is paired with a screenshot from the site.

Before you begin

Use an email account you can access for verification and password recovery. The site describes file encryption as occurring in the browser before upload. The examples in this guide have been anonymized: private values and verification codes are hidden.

At a glance

Register or sign in; verify your account by email when prompted; send files from Upload; receive them in Inbox; manage credentials in Change Password; and use the administrator area for account and audit review when your account has that role.

Live site: https://secure-file-sharing-with-encryption-tau.vercel.app/
Prepared: 11 October 2026

1. Start at the home page

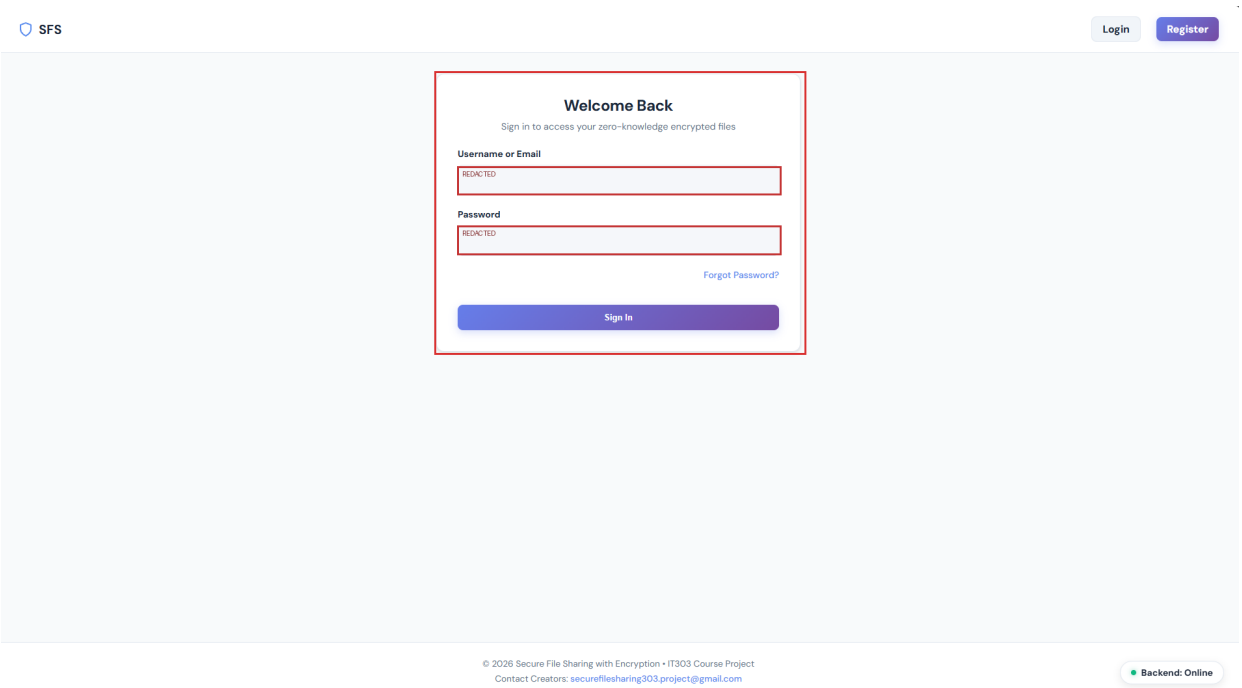
Open the live site. Choose **Register** to create an account or **Login** if you already have one. The home page describes the service's encryption and delivery features.



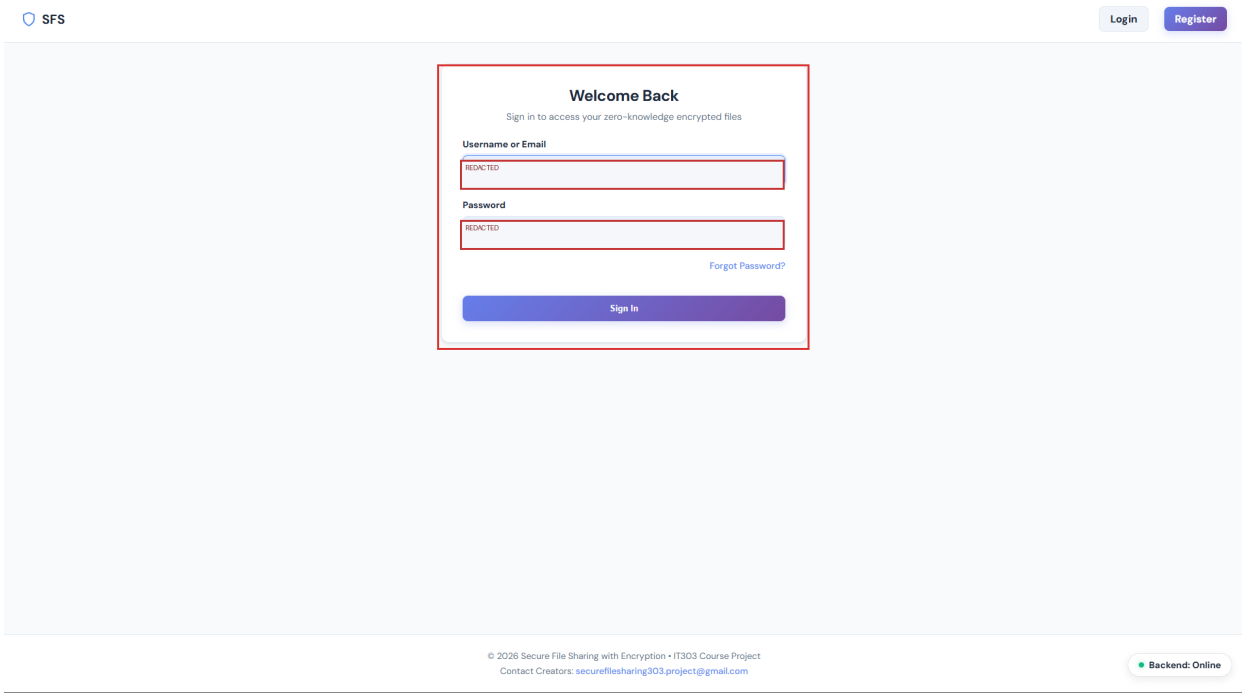
Home page. Red rectangles point out the account entry actions and main feature area.

2. Sign in

1. Select **Login** and enter your username or email address.
2. Enter your password. The eye icon can show or hide the value while you type.
3. Select **Sign In**. If the site requests an extra verification step, continue to Section 3.



Sign-in form with the username and password fields identified.



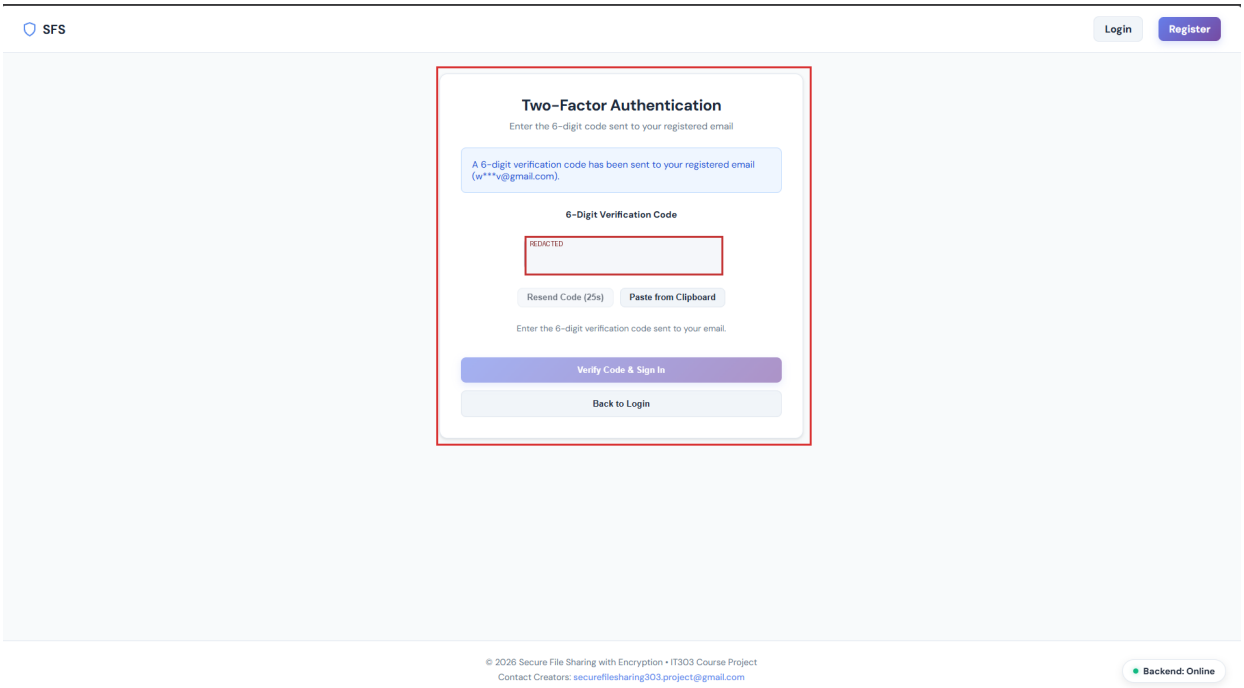
Example of the filled sign-in form. Entered values are redacted.

3. Complete email verification

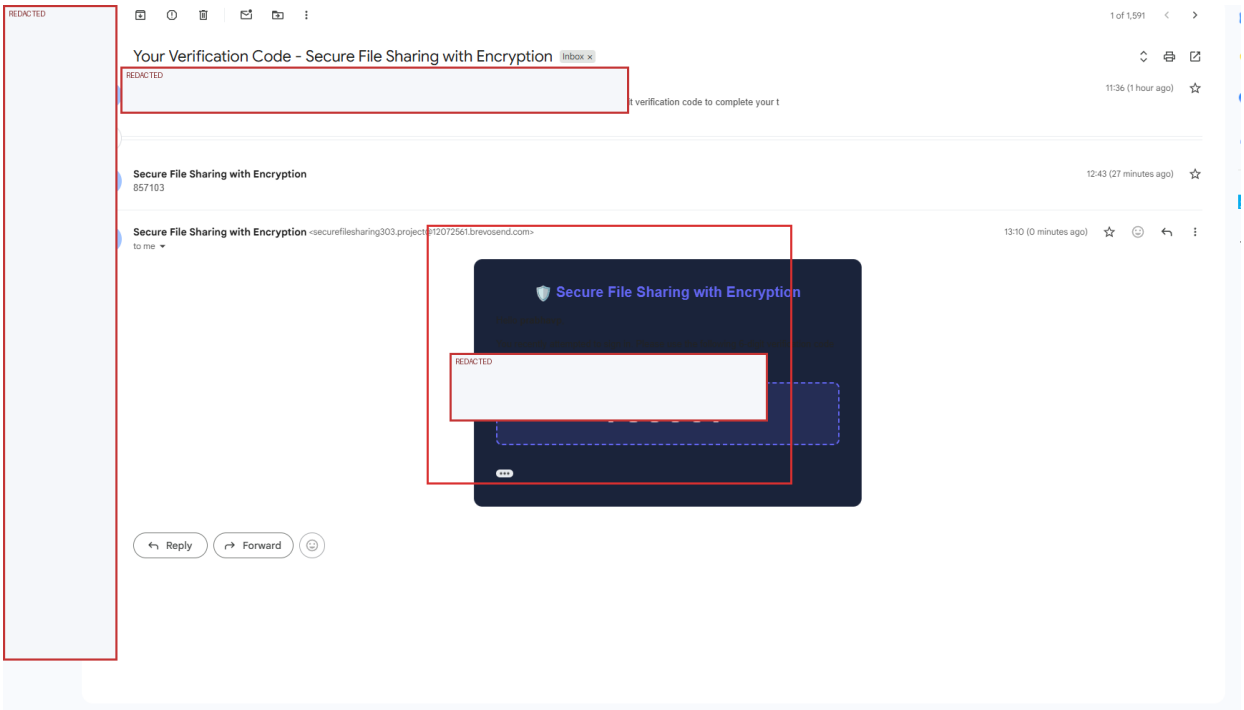
When prompted, the site sends a six-digit verification code to the registered email address.

1. Open the verification email and note the current code.
2. Enter all six digits in the code field. Use **Paste from Clipboard** if you copied the code.
3. Select **Verify Code & Sign In**. If the code has expired or is missing, use **Resend Code** when it becomes available.

Treat the code as private: do not share it or include it in a message to anyone.



Verification page. The email address and code entry are concealed; the resend, paste, and verification actions are outlined.



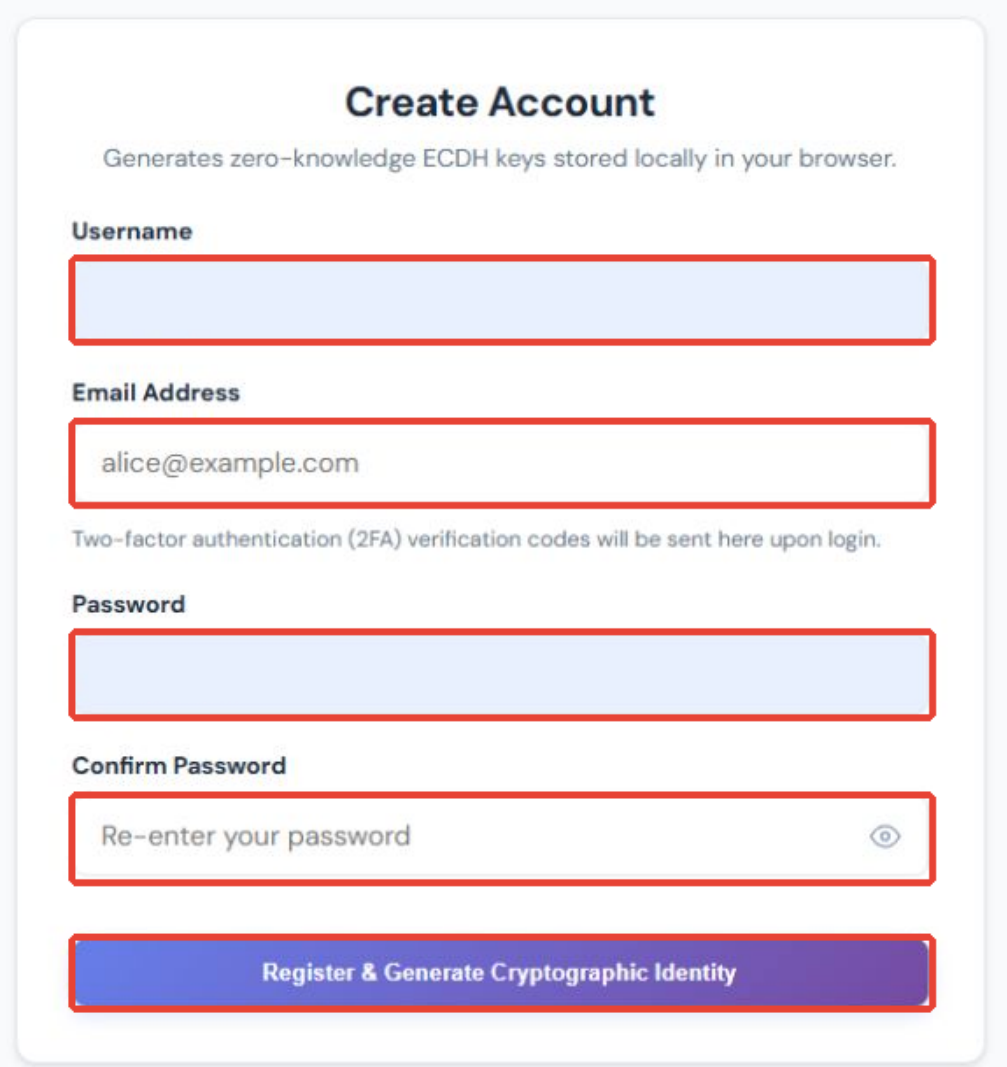
Verification email example. Inbox details and the one-time code are concealed.

4. Create an account

1. Select **Register** from the home page.
2. Enter a username and an email address you can access.
3. Choose a password and enter it again in the confirmation field. Use the eye controls if you need to check your typing.

4. Select the registration button to create the account and generate its cryptographic identity.

The registration screen indicates that generated key material is kept in the browser. Keep access to the same browser profile and avoid clearing its site data unless you understand the effect on your account's locally stored identity.

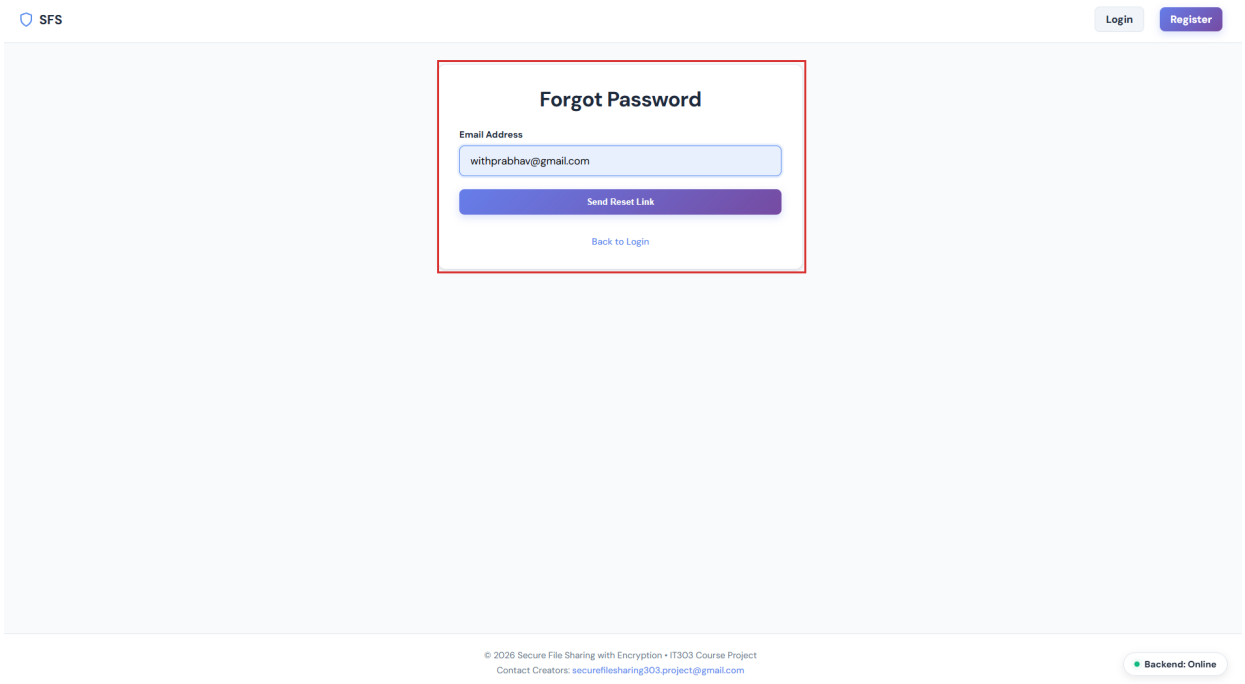


Registration form from the earlier capture; entered personal values are hidden.

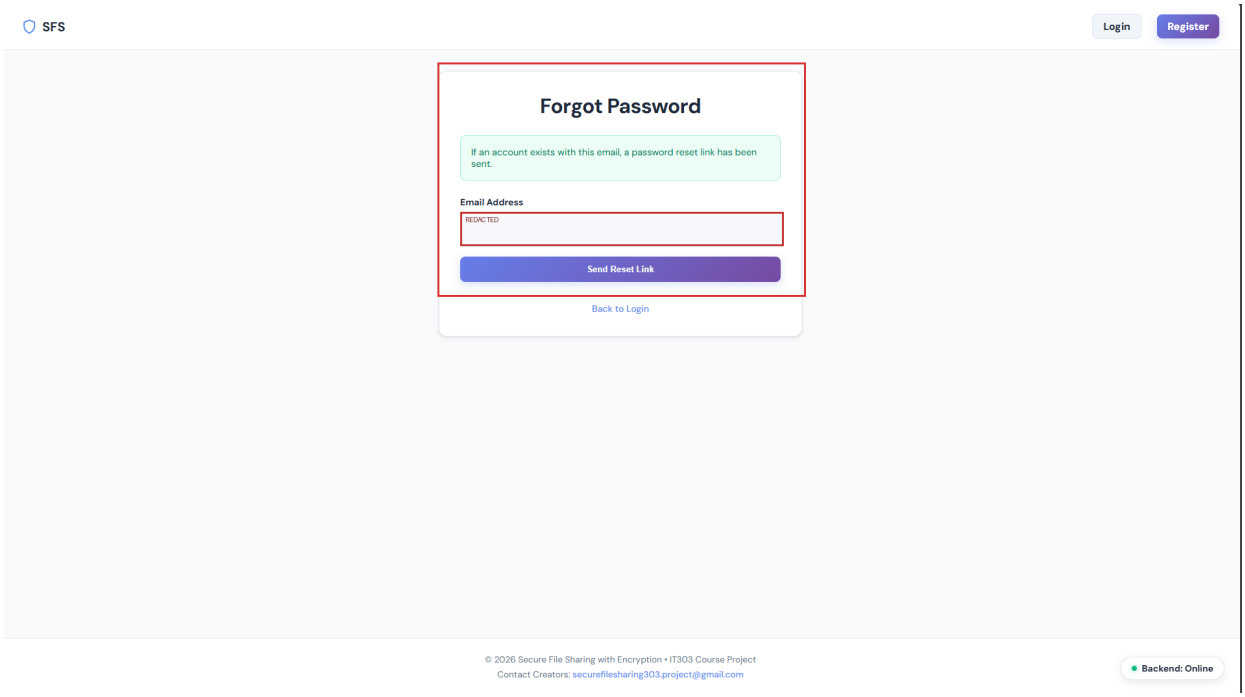
5. Recover a forgotten password

1. On the sign-in form, select **Forgot Password?**.
2. Enter the email address associated with your account and choose **Send Reset Link**.
3. Check your inbox for a message from Secure File Sharing with Encryption. Open it and select **Reset Password**.
4. If you return to the sign-in page, use **Back to Login**.

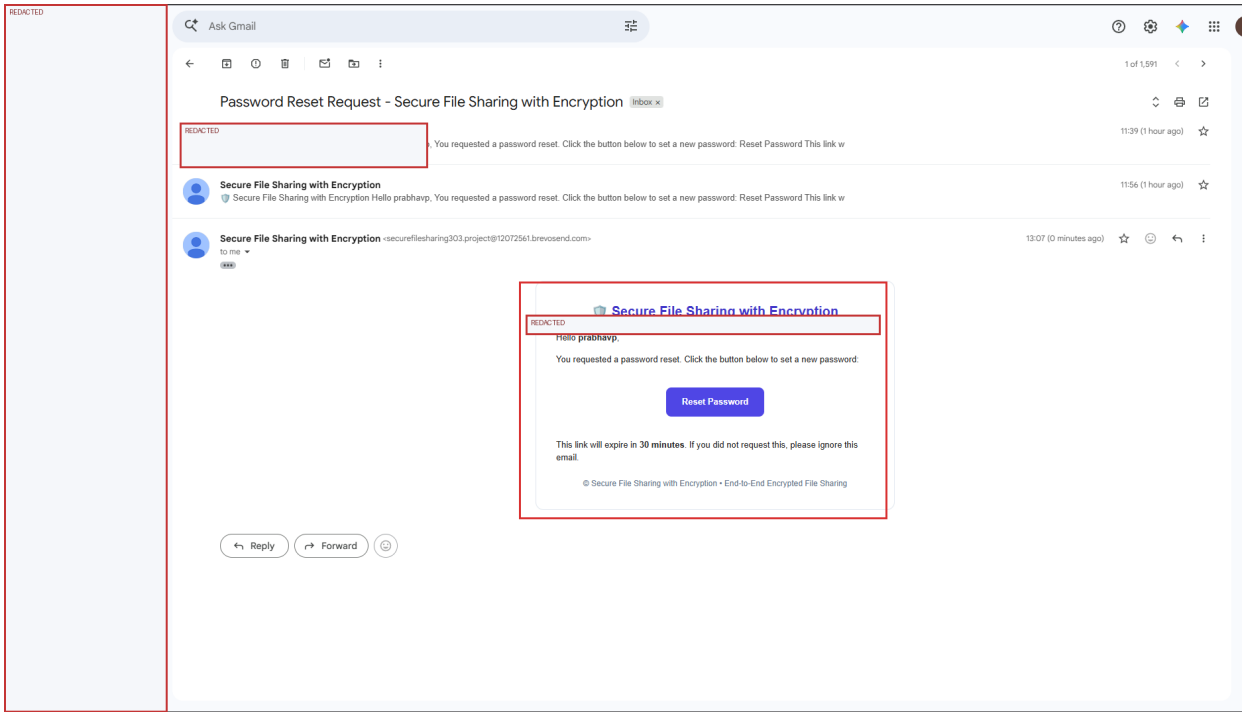
The site displays a general confirmation that a link was sent if an account exists for the address.



Forgot-password form and its send action.



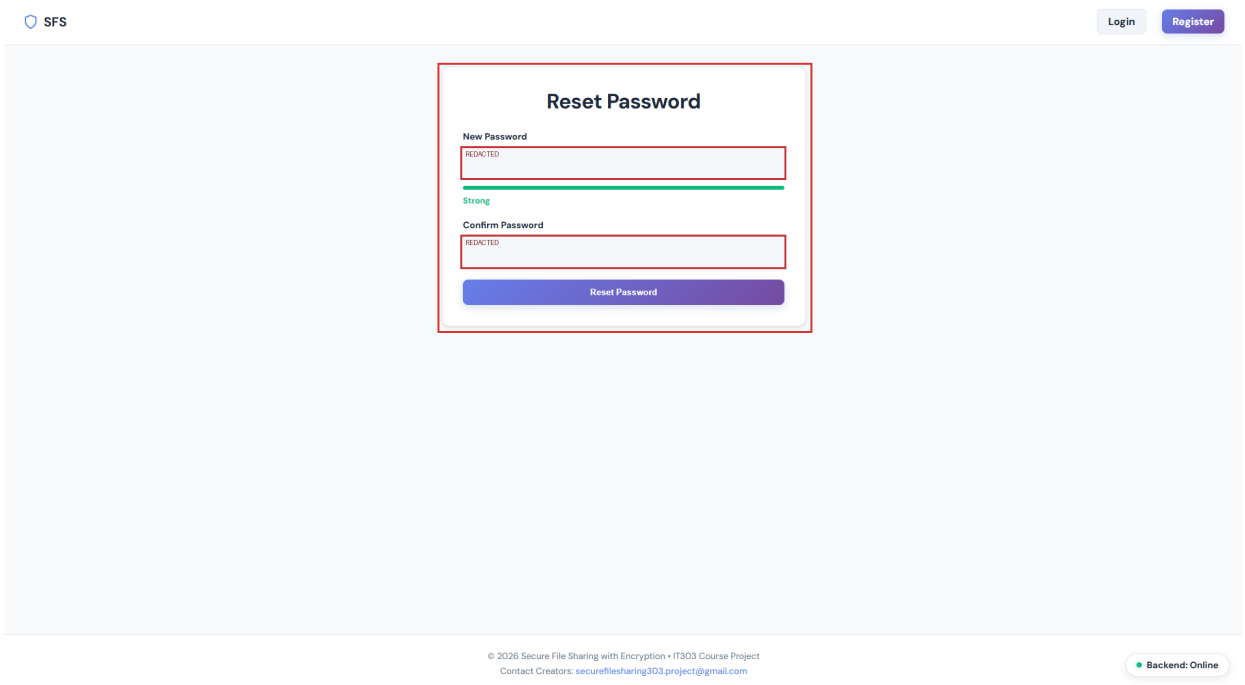
Reset-link request confirmation. The email value is concealed.



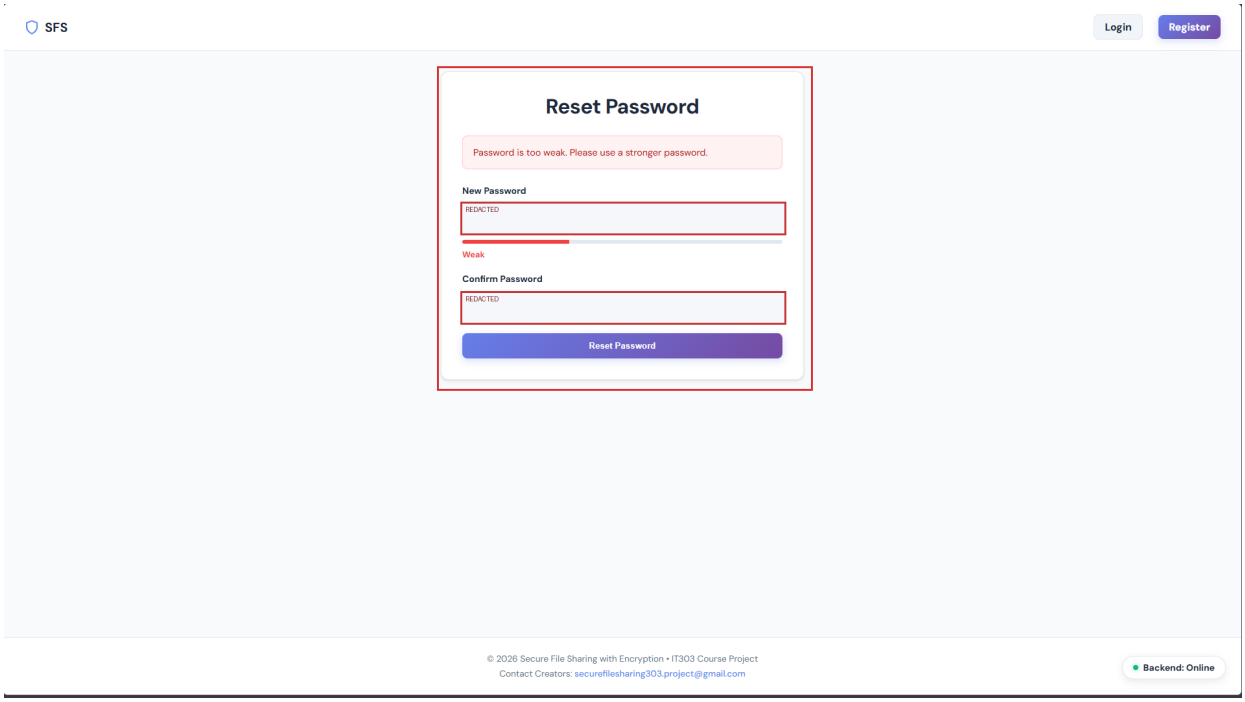
Password-reset email example. Mailbox details and personal information are hidden.

6. Set a new password from a reset link

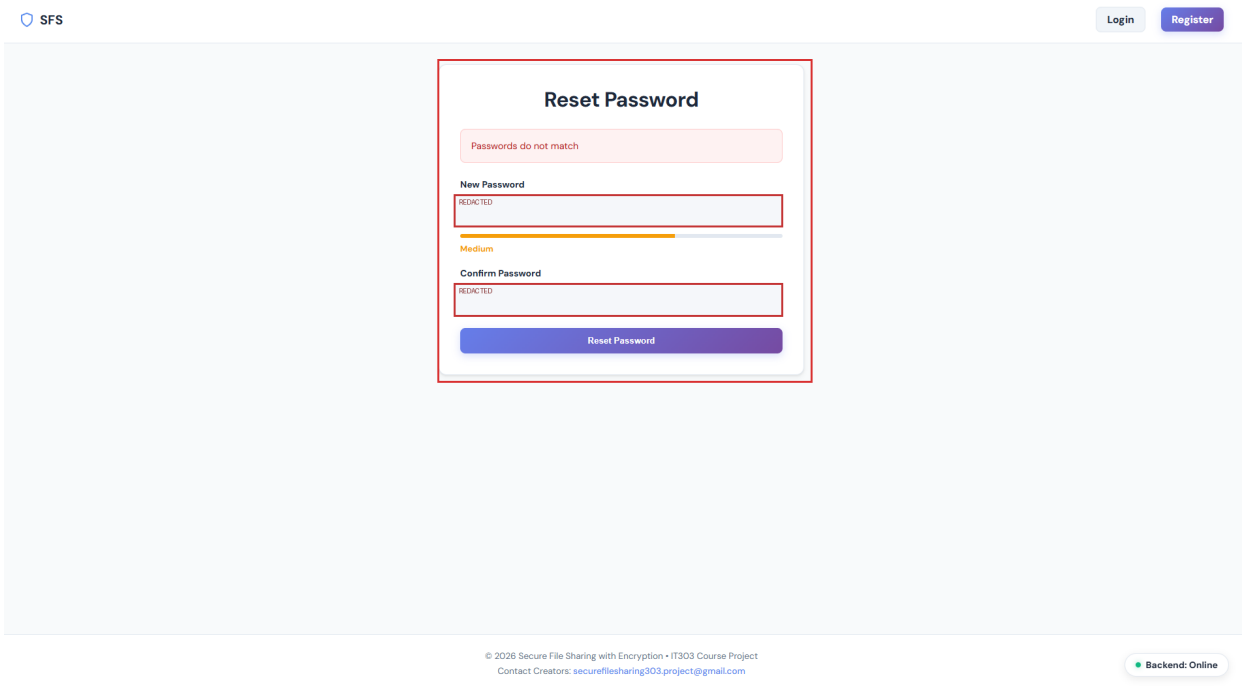
1. Open the reset link from the email before it expires.
2. Enter a new password, then enter the same value in **Confirm Password**.
3. Check the password-strength indicator and correct any warning shown.
4. Select **Reset Password**. If the page reports a mismatch, make both entries identical and try again.



Reset form with a strong-password indicator; both password values are hidden.



Weak-password feedback. Choose a stronger password before submitting.



Mismatch feedback. Re-enter the same new password in both fields.

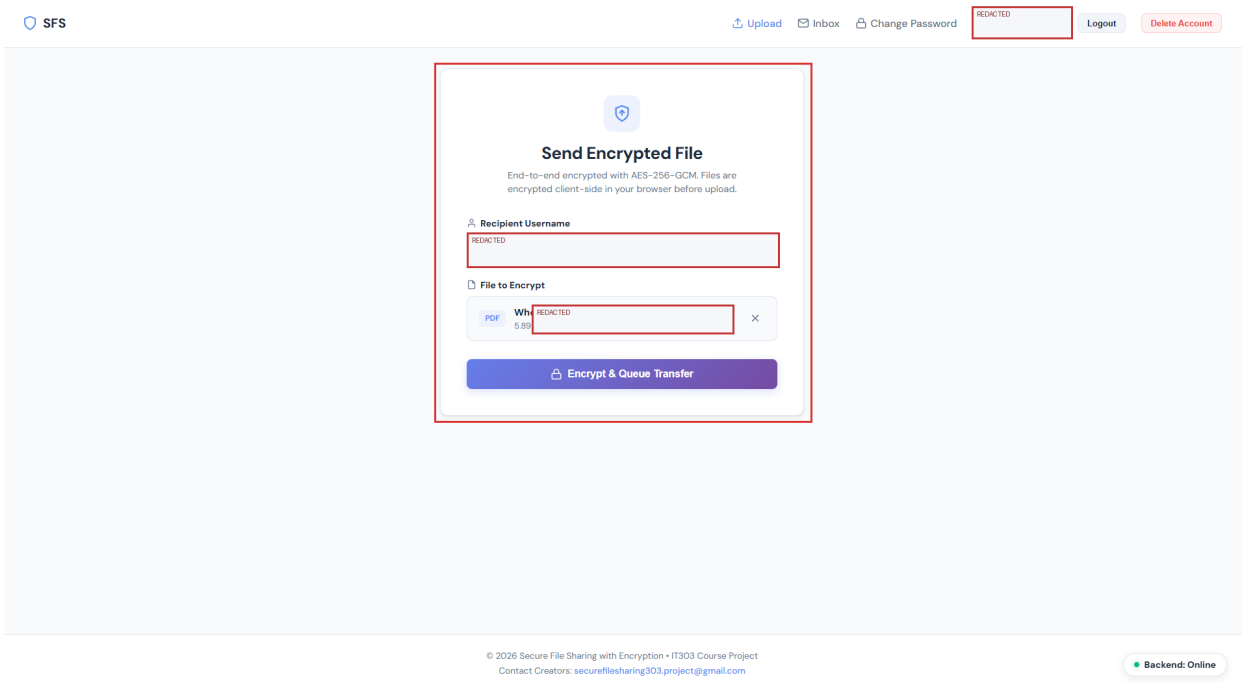
7. Send an encrypted file

Select **Upload** from the signed-in navigation bar.

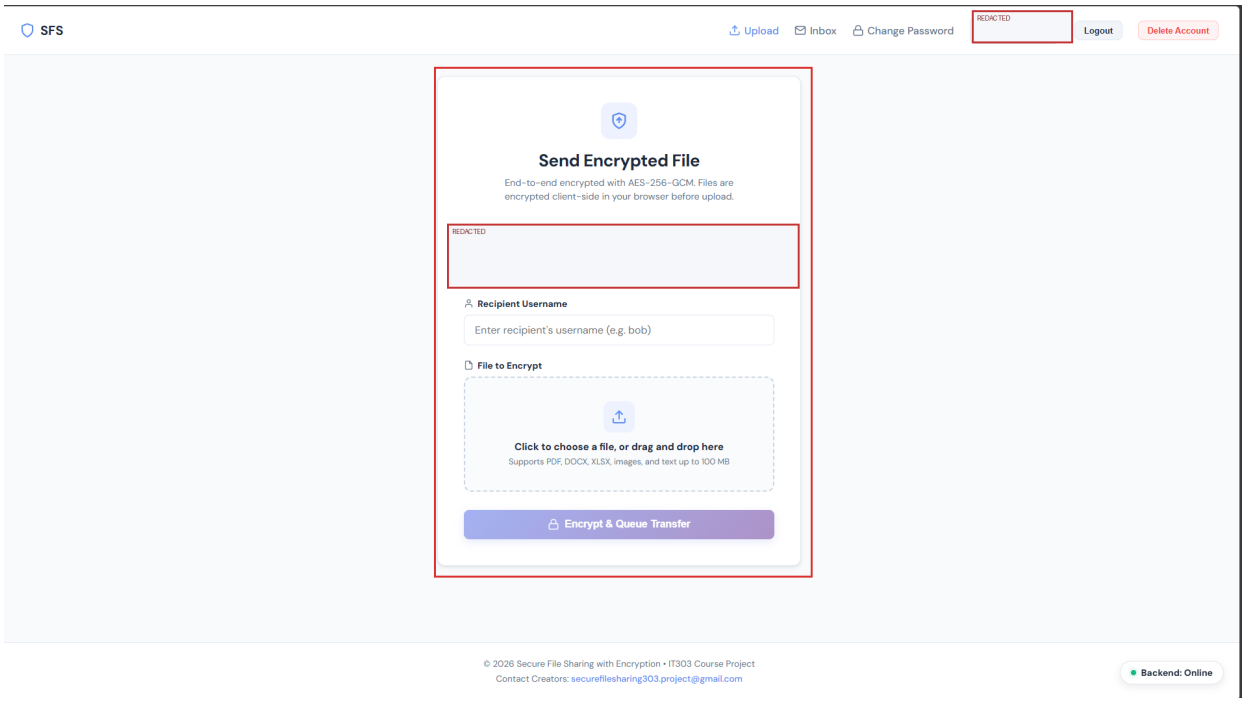
1. Enter the recipient's **username**. Check its spelling with the recipient.
2. Select a file in the upload area, or drag and drop it. The screen lists PDF, DOCX, XLSX, images, and text files, up to 100 MB.

3. Confirm the selected file and recipient, then select **Encrypt & Queue Transfer**.
4. Wait for the success message confirming that the encrypted file was queued. The recipient can then check their Inbox.

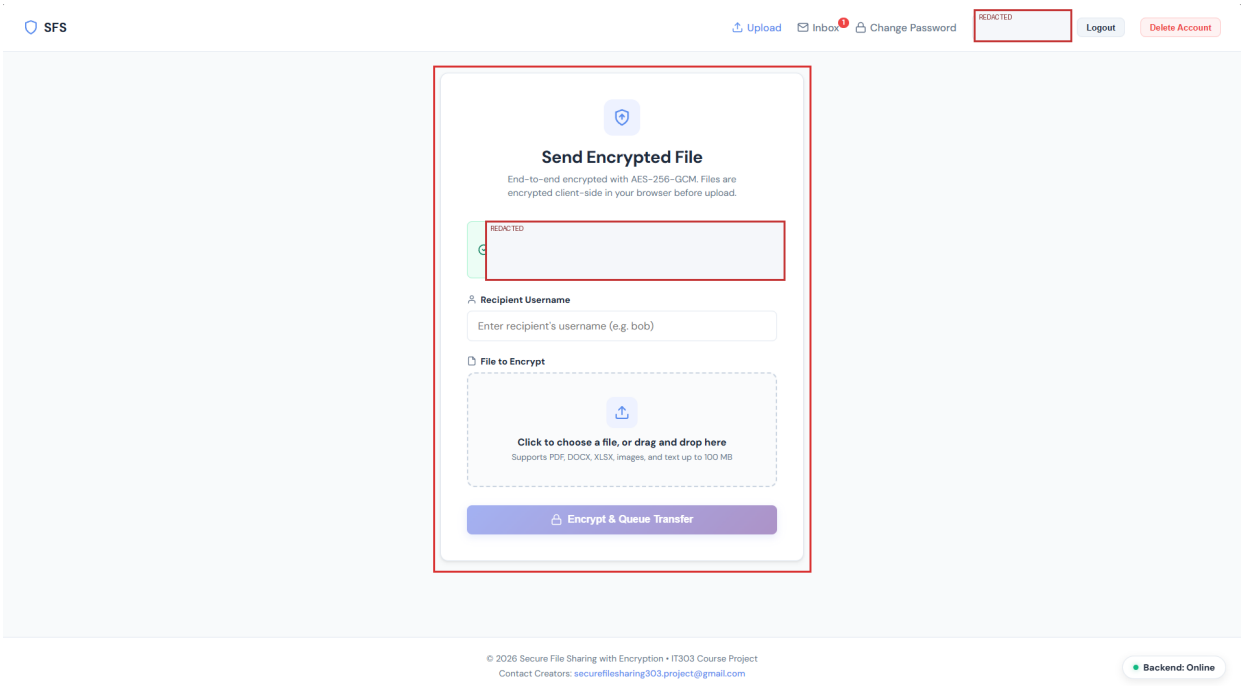
The interface describes AES-256-GCM encryption in the browser before upload. Send only to the intended username. Screenshots conceal the example recipient, filename, and transfer identifier.



Upload form with the recipient, chosen-file row, and queue action highlighted. Personal values are hidden.



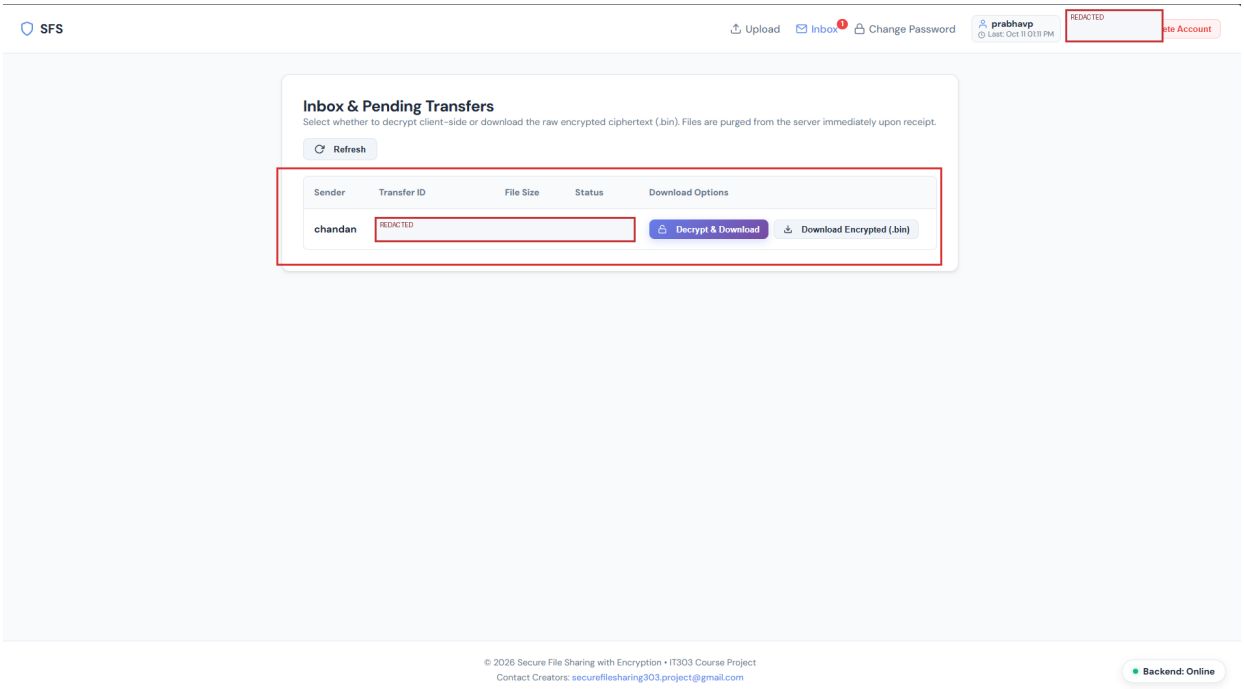
Successful queue confirmation. Filename, account name, and transfer identifier are concealed.



Upload form after a successful queue action; the success notice and Inbox indicator are highlighted.

8. Receive a file

1. Select **Inbox**. Choose **Refresh** if the expected transfer is not listed.
2. Check the sender and transfer row with the person who sent the file.
3. Choose **Decrypt & Download** to receive the readable file, or **Download Encrypted (.bin)** to save the encrypted ciphertext.
4. Save the downloaded file somewhere you can find it. The Inbox says files are purged from the server upon receipt.

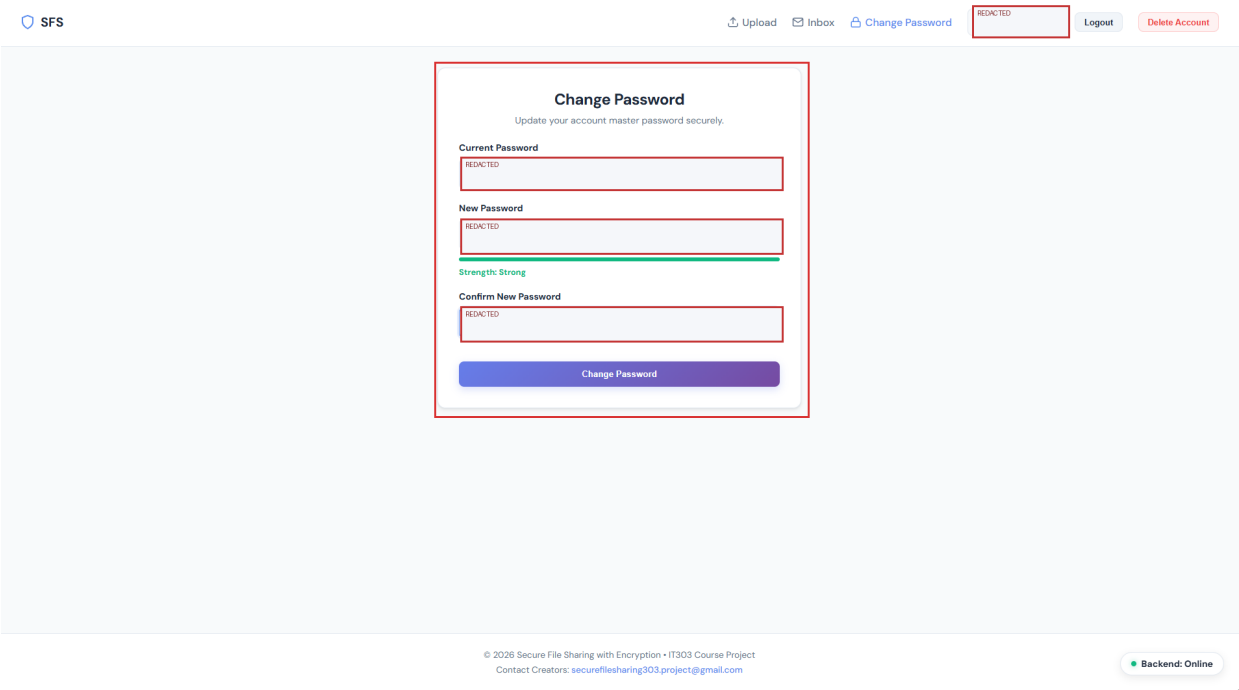


Pending transfer row. The sender and transfer details are hidden; both download choices are outlined.

9. Change your password

Select **Change Password** in the navigation bar.

1. Enter your current password.
2. Enter a new password and confirm it in the final field.
3. Review the strength indicator, then select **Change Password**.



Change-password form. Entered values and account details are concealed.

10. Log out

Select **Logout** in the navigation bar when you have finished. You will return to the public part of the site; sign in again when you want to continue.

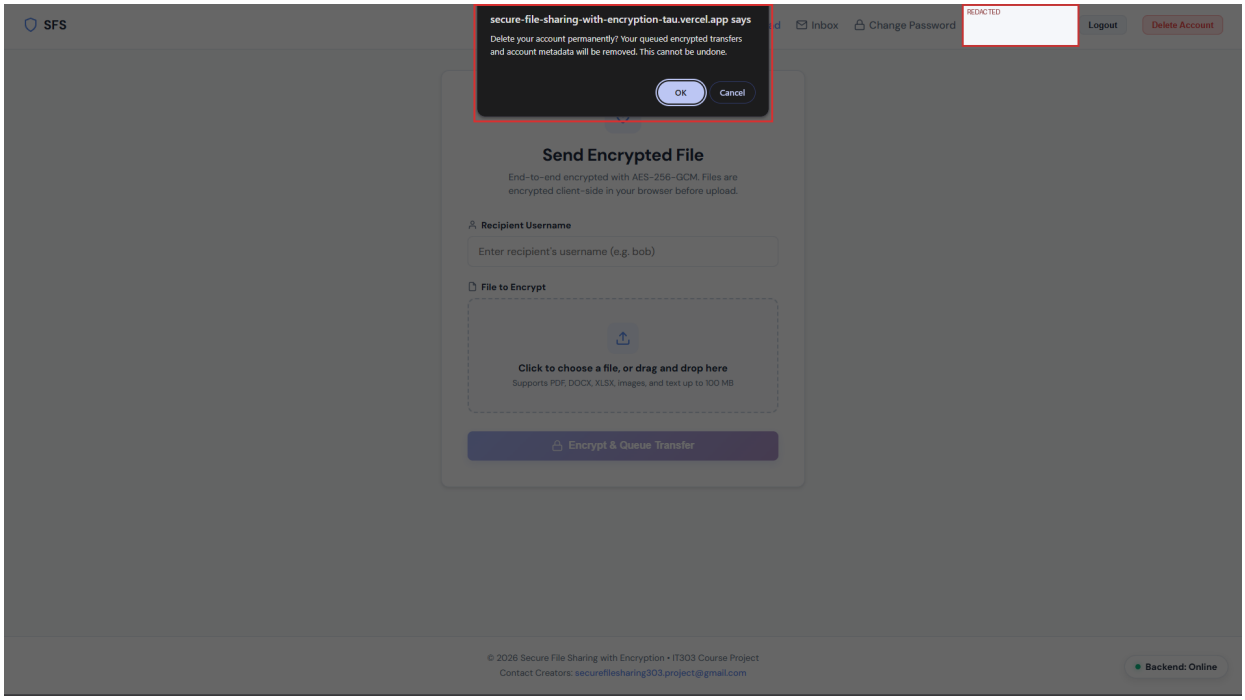


Signed-in navigation captured earlier. Account details are hidden.

11. Delete your account

Account deletion is permanent and removes account metadata and queued encrypted transfers, as the confirmation warns.

1. Select **Delete Account** only when you intend to remove the account.
2. Read the confirmation carefully. Choose **Cancel** to keep the account, or confirm only if you accept the deletion.
3. After confirming, the site returns to the public home page and displays a completion notice.



Deletion confirmation. Review the warning and choose deliberately.

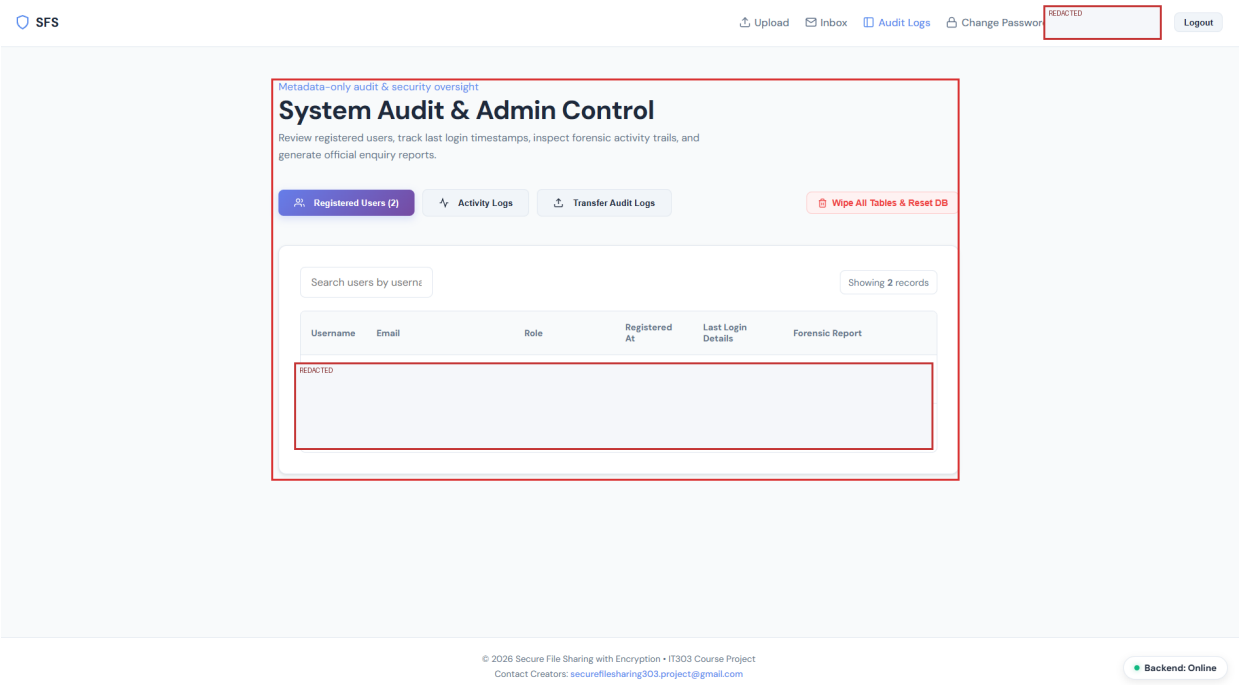


Completion notice after account deletion.

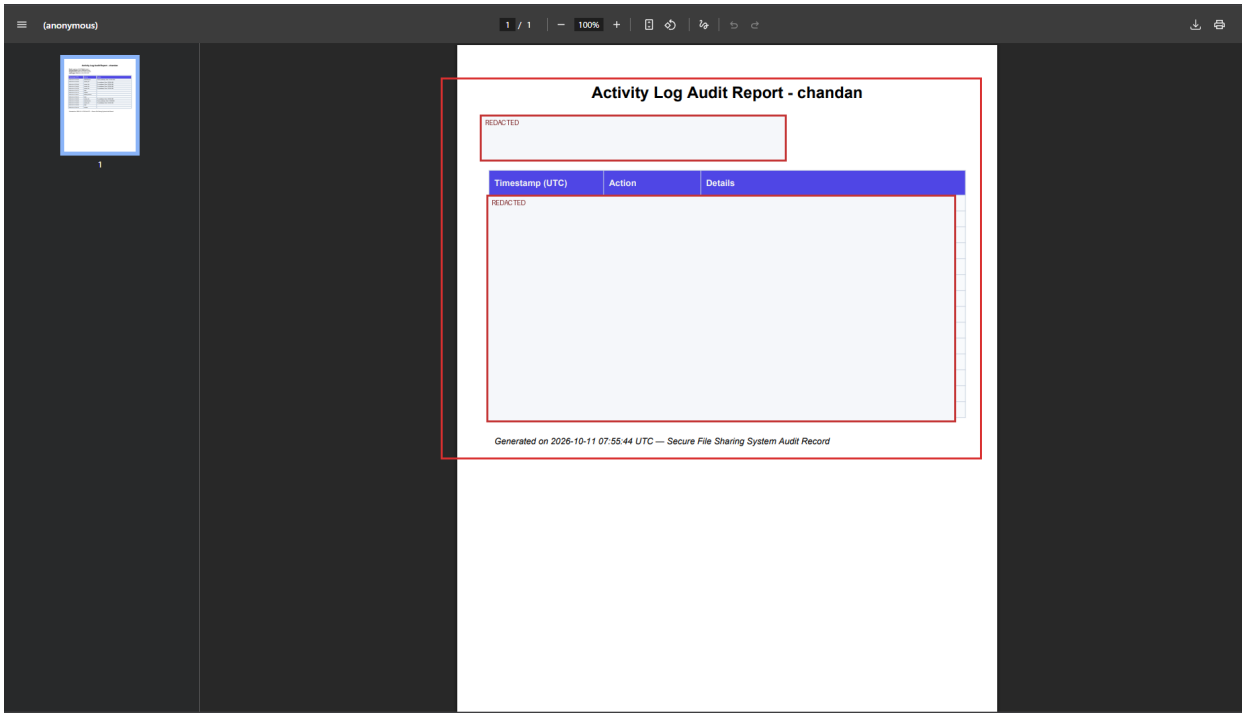
12. Administrator: review users and audit activity

These actions are available only to an administrator. The dashboard provides user records, activity logs, transfer audit logs, and per-user report actions.

1. Open **Audit Logs** from the administrator navigation.
2. Use the registered-users view and search field to locate a record.
3. Select **View Logs** to inspect a user's activity, or **Export PDF** to produce a report.
4. Use the **Activity Logs** and **Transfer Audit Logs** tabs to review the corresponding records.



Administrator dashboard. Record values are concealed; navigation, audit tabs, and report actions are outlined.



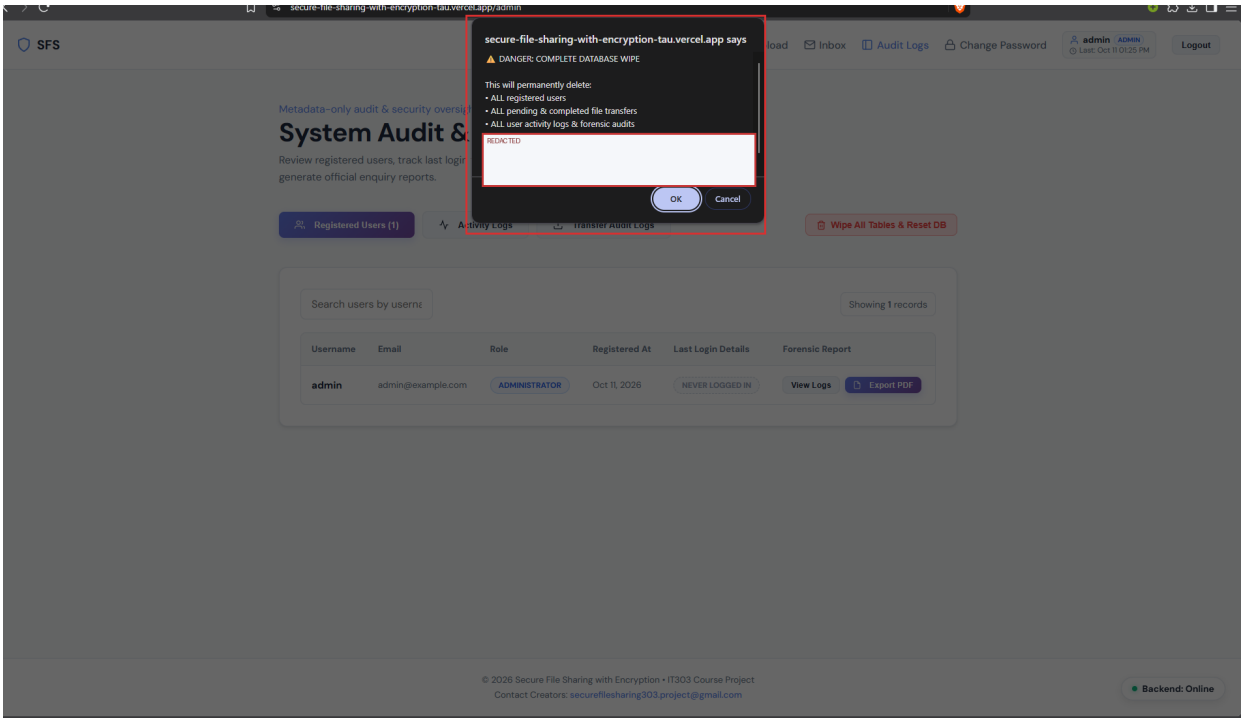
Example exported audit report. User details and event values are concealed.



Activity log list. Personal details are concealed; action types and report controls remain visible.

13. Administrator: reset the database

The dashboard's **Wipe All Tables & Reset DB** action is destructive. Its confirmation warns that user accounts, transfers, logs, and stored encrypted blobs will be permanently removed. Read the complete confirmation before proceeding. Cancel if you are not authorized to reset the database or do not intend to erase this data.



Database-wipe confirmation. The default administrator credential shown in the original capture has been concealed.

Screenshot key

Red rectangles identify controls discussed in the nearby steps. Solid pale panels marked **REDACTED** conceal private values from the supplied examples. Screens show example states; available records, messages, and controls depend on the account and current site state.